

# BEN HANKINS

*Solutions Engineer | Pre-Sales Technical Strategy, Enterprise Discovery & AI Systems*  
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## PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

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Solutions Engineer with 7+ years across the full customer technical lifecycle: discovery, POC, and technical evaluation through production deployment. Spent five years in IBM Client Engineering across 12 named enterprise accounts, supporting \$13M in pipeline anchored by a \$10.1M engagement at CenterPoint Energy, where hands-on Terraform and OpenShift work turned technical evaluations into signed, deployed infrastructure. Works across AWS, GCP, and IBM Cloud in regulated industries, combining customer-facing discovery with infrastructure depth and hands-on delivery from demo through deployment.

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

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|---------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Pre-Sales &amp; Delivery</b> | Technical Discovery, Solution Design, Stakeholder Alignment, POC Execution, Customer Enablement, SOC 2 Compliance Architecture                                          |
| <b>Cloud &amp; Platform</b>     | AWS (EKS, EC2, S3, IAM, Route 53, CloudWatch), IBM Cloud, GCP, Kubernetes (EKS, GKE, OpenShift/ROKS), Terraform, Helm, Argo CD / GitOps, Tekton, Ansible, Docker, CI/CD |
| <b>IBM AI &amp; Data</b>        | Cloud Pak for Data, Cloud Pak for Business Automation, watsonx.ai, watsonx.governance, Watson OpenScale, Watson Assistant, Automated Decision Services (ADS)            |
| <b>Development</b>              | TypeScript, React, Next.js, Node.js, Python, REST APIs, SQL, Auth (JWT/RBAC), PostgreSQL, Supabase, n8n                                                                 |
| <b>AI / LLM</b>                 | LLM Application Architecture, RAG Pipelines, Multi-Agent Systems, Prompt Engineering & Evaluation, AI Governance, Agentic Coding (Claude Code, Codex)                   |

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

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### Founder & Solutions Engineer

Sep 2025 - Present

[Sproutflow Studio](#) - New Orleans, LA

- Own the end-to-end technical sales cycle for small-business clients, from discovery and proposal through solution scoping, delivery, handoff, and retainer expansion.
- Converted 3 one-time projects into recurring retainers covering uptime monitoring, security patching, and version-controlled deployments.
- Delivered measurable client outcomes: a 30% increase in customers for NOLA Pool Solutions, a 120% increase in bookings for Nealy's Event Decor, and a 25% increase in inquiries for DJN Services LLC after launching its first digital presence.

### Site Reliability Engineer

Jan 2025 - Sep 2025

[Prove AI](#) - Remote

- Drove SOC 2 Type II from a 34% Vanta baseline to a passed audit in six months under the CISO. Starting from company-wide open access with no policies in place, authored least-privilege IAM across the org, established repository security and branch-protection rules, and owned policy authoring and evidence collection across production infrastructure.
- Kept production stable across 4 Kubernetes clusters with a single incident in nine months, and introduced structured, automated CI/CD (GitHub Actions, Helm) where deployments had been manual and ad hoc, cutting deployment time roughly 80%.
- Built OpenSearch dashboards for error tracing across all services and environments, with severity-based filtering that cut mean time to resolution 67%.

### IBM, Client Engineering

2019 - 2024

[Austin, TX](#) - Remote

Named accounts: AT&T, Boeing, Cencora, CenterPoint Energy, Hertz, Honeywell, Juniper Networks, Kroger, NBCUniversal, Norfolk Southern, PepsiCo, Verizon

## Cloud Infrastructure Engineer

Apr 2023 - Aug 2024

- Stood up Cencora's move from ODM to Automated Decision Services on CP4BA/OpenShift: configured ADS, installed the Nexus Repository Operator for artifact management, and authored a reusable deployment runbook supporting a \$200K ADS opportunity.
- For a separate NDA-covered enterprise client, authored the Terraform / IBM Schematics codebase for VPCs, compute, security groups, bastion hosts, storage, and load balancers. The automation reduced a multi-hour build to roughly 4 minutes and enabled 29 additional deployments for 31 total environments while I supported concurrent accounts and led skill transfer.
- Built and supported Cloud Pak for Business Automation infrastructure on OpenShift, including IBM Schematics patterns, deployment runbooks, and customer enablement across concurrent accounts.

## Cloud Engineer (Client-Facing Solutions Engineering)

Feb 2021 - Mar 2023

- Built client-facing MVPs and demos including AT&T's Connected Transportation UI (Next.js + Google Maps, geofencing, EMV markers, Snap-to-Roads routing) and Boeing's HR/job-description prototype (React, Carbon, D3); executed POCs and live demos that advanced technical evaluations toward signing.
- Proactively trained on Terraform ahead of client demand, then led architecture scoping and the technical evaluation that helped close CenterPoint Energy's \$10.1M SAP RISE engagement as the only Terraform specialist in the department. I remained embedded for production delivery, starting from 2 existing environments, building 1 test environment, and deploying 49 additional environments for 52 total using Terraform and Helm.
- Built reusable Terraform automation and helped configure and deploy Cloud Pak for Multicloud Management for client-facing technical evaluations across AWS, GCP, and IBM Cloud.
- Worked hands-on with watsonx.governance and Watson OpenScale for AI model governance and evaluation, configuring prompt evaluation and custom quality monitors; mentored junior technical specialists through discovery frameworks, POC shadowing, and an IBM patent filing.

## Client Technical Specialist (Solutions Engineering)

Dec 2019 - Jan 2021

- Led technical discovery and delivered proofs of concept across Cloud Pak for Data, Cloud Pak for Business Automation, and Cloud Pak for Multicloud Management. Configured and deployed the platforms on OpenShift and ROKS using TechZone, OLM, custom resources, Argo CD, Kustomize, Tekton, storage classes, and pull secrets. Promoted after 14 months.
- Modernized client Java applications for cloud scalability and built Tekton CI/CD pipelines, reducing deployment times 35%.

## Front End Developer (Contract)

Jan 2019 - Jun 2019

[Kortivity](#) - Austin, TX

- Designed, built, and maintained a Vue-based web scraper Chrome extension enabling recruiters to scrape candidate profiles and gather contact information for outreach, directly supporting the company's core recruiting workflow.

## PROJECTS

[greenlit.cv](#) -- Live AI resume-scoring and coaching SaaS: a deterministic ATS analyzer paired with an industry-aware AI narrative layer, with Stripe checkout. Next.js 15, TypeScript, Vercel Postgres, Gemini. Live at [greenlit.cv](#).

[business-plan-writer](#) -- Public preview of a review-gated business-plan system on a five-agent pipeline: validation, parallel market and financial analysis, drafting, critique, and bounded revision. FastAPI, Next.js, Supabase, Anthropic, Groq, and OpenAI.

[solutions-playbook](#) -- Public field guide for Solutions Engineering and Architecture practice: 70+ frameworks, templates, and diagrams across discovery, POC scoping, implementation, and executive communication.

[ai-engineering-studio](#) -- Public translation layer for AI engineering: LLM apps, RAG, agents, evals, and governance made legible for technical and business audiences, with seven hands-on labs.

## EDUCATION

**B.A. Communication & Media Studies**

2017

[Mississippi State University](#)

**Software Engineering Bootcamp**

2018

[General Assembly](#)

## CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate (2026)